CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

VIRTUAL ASSISTANT IN THE AI ERA

The virtual assistant is now literally virtual. The software took the job title as a compliment.

★ TL;DR — NO. Median ~$45K — the lowest on this list — with a 1–6 month ramp into the exact task pile AI agents were built to eat. The roadmap below is the way OUT, not in. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

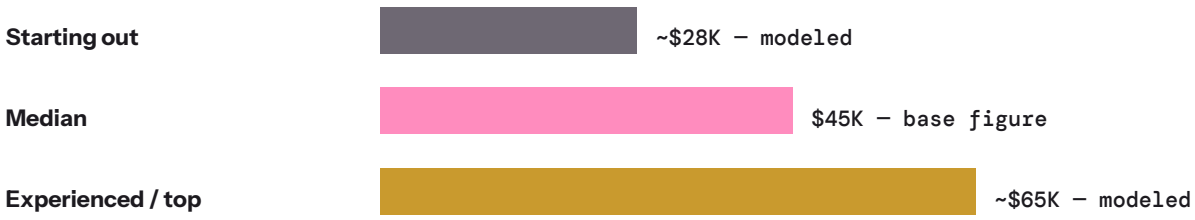
OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK HIGH

- Fails as a start because: inbox, scheduling, data entry and research are the demo tasks of every AI agent product.
- The money problem: a ~$45K median while clients replace assistant hours with subscriptions that cost less than one hour of you.
- Still worth money: you know how messy businesses actually run. The person who sets up the systems beats the person the systems replaced.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Virtual Assistant is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A VIRTUAL ASSISTANT ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Run inboxes and calendars: triage, schedule, chase, reschedule
- ✓ Enter and clean data in spreadsheets and CRMs
- ✓ Research, book travel, format documents, post content
- ✓ Be the reliable pair of hands for whatever the owner drops

Think: an excellent stagehand in a theater that just automated the rigging — the show still needs someone, but not backstage pulling ropes.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Scheduling, inbox triage, meeting notes, data entry, basic research, reminders, travel options — agent software demos exactly this list, on purpose.	Judgment about a specific boss's chaos: what matters, who matters, what 'handle it' means here. That insider knowledge is the bridge to owning the systems.

⚠ **THE SUBSCRIPTION MATH: your competition is not another VA. It's a tool your client already pays for, which added an assistant feature last quarter.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Variety: no two days or clients alike ✓ Remote, flexible hours, low barrier to start ✓ You see how real businesses run from the inside	✗ Not defensible: every task on your list is a product roadmap item somewhere ✗ Not well paid: a $45K median with clients trained to expect cheap ✗ Not a ladder: years of VA work rarely convert into a senior title

Good fit? Already a VA embedded with one business that trusts you — your move is up into its operations and systems, fast, before the tools arrive.
Bad fit? Beginners starting VA work as the plan for 2027 income. You'd be training for the demo video of the thing replacing you.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO AI Automation Specialist	DOOR B — PIVOT TO Salesforce Administrator

The ~$120K figure attached to this job is the BLS median of its closest degree-gated analogue — Data Scientists, $120,230, +35% growth — not a measured wage for freelance automation builders, which nobody publishes. The direction is right and the entry is fast; just don't budget the analogue's salary for month three. You already know which tasks eat a business owner's week; now you wire the agent that does them and charge for the system. First move: take your most repetitive client task and automate it end to end; that before/after is your sales pitch.	~$75K is the ENTRY figure here, not the middle: surveyed Salesforce admin medians run ~$99–110K (Mason Frank's 2026 survey puts the median at $110,000). And it comes with a real credential: the CRM you used to type into becomes the system you own. Data hygiene, workflows, reports — your data-entry years turn into admin judgment that companies hire by name. First move: get into a free Salesforce training environment and rebuild a contact pipeline you once maintained by hand.

Smart move: If you're already a VA: this month, offer your client one automation as a fixed-price project. The first system you sell reprices you from hours to outcomes.
Where you land after: You land on the other side of the tool — building and running the systems — with your insider knowledge as the unfair advantage.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PICK YOUR	LEARN ONE	BUILD THE	ADD THE	SELL TO	REPRICE YOURSELF

STEP 1 — Pick your side of the tool

FREE · TODAY

- Write down your 5 most repeated tasks — those are products now, not duties
- Choose the builder path: you will sell systems, not hours

STEP 2 — Learn one automation stack

SELF-PACED · 2–3 WEEKS

- One AI agent/workflow builder, learned on your own task list
- Automate your inbox triage or scheduling end to end

STEP 3 — Build the proof

FREE · 2 WEEKS

- Package one automation with a before/after: hours in, hours saved
- Record a short walkthrough — this is your portfolio now

STEP 4 — Add the admin credential track

SELF-PACED · 3-4 WEEKS

- Start Salesforce admin training in the free environment
- Rebuild one pipeline you used to maintain manually

STEP 5 — Sell to the warmest room

FREE · ONGOING

- Offer one fixed-price automation to a current or past client
- Apply to automation and Salesforce admin roles with the proof attached

STEP 6 — Reprice yourself

FREE · ONGOING

- Take the first systems project or seat
- VA skills stay in the toolbox — as diagnostics, not as the offer

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: list your five most repeated tasks. Those are your product catalog now.
- □ Days 1–30: learn the automation stack on your own work; finish the before/after demo.
- □ Days 31–60: Salesforce admin basics running; pitch one fixed-price automation to a warm client.
- □ Days 61–90: first paid system or admin seat; keep shipping small automations weekly.
- □ Day 90: you're the person businesses hire to install the assistant — not the assistant being installed over.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **BE THE BUILDER, NOT THE FEATURE** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. labor-market data (this title has no separate BLS occupation; the figure is a market/anchor estimate)). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.